

the first two-time EA SPORTS FC world champion and only the second player to lift the Esports World Cup trophy—a true underdog story.

Despite being a former world champion (2023), ManuBachoore had to qualify through the FC Pro World Championship Play-Ins, a tougher path than standard qualifiers.

"I came here through the play-ins. I wasn't even sure I'd qualify for the tournament," ManuBachoore told the EWC website. "I say it every tournament, but it's a dream."

Meanwhile, Brice endured a forgettable season, crashing out in the first round of the eChampions League without a single win.

FOOTBALL LEGENDS FACE OFF

Football fever gripped the EWC as Ballon d'Or winners Kaká and Ronaldo Nazário faced off in an EA Sports FC exhibition match.

Kaká dominated his former teammate 3-0 in a best-of-three series (3-2, 11-6, 3-2). Ronaldo took the loss in good spirits, vowing revenge in Call of Duty next time:

"Next time, next year, we play Warzone," he said with a smile.



TEAM ORANGUTAN WINS IQOO BATTLEGROUND SERIES

The inaugural iQOO Battlegrounds Series, featuring a ₹1 crore prize pool, concluded on August 10 in Noida, with Team Orangutan emerging victorious with a 61-point lead and taking home ₹55 lakh.

The tournament began on July 21 with 32 teams—30 invited and two qualifying via the

Community Cup.

"Four years ago, it was just a dream. Today, it's in our hands. Every setback, every close call, every tough day only made us stronger. We never gave up, and that made all the difference," said Arman "Aaru", Orangutan's in-game leader (IGL).

Meta Ninja (156 points) and K9 Esports (121 points) secured second and third place, respectively. Ankit "AKop" Shukla of Orangutan was named MVP with 62 finishes in the finals.

"The iQOO Battlegrounds Series is a perfect example of performance-driven innovation meeting grassroots talent and world-class tournament execution. Congratulations to Orangutan on a well-deserved victory," said Akshat Rathee, co-founder of NODWIN Gaming, the tournament's organiser.



Did you know? Chelsea legend César Azpilicueta founded a Spanish esports organisation named Falcons in 2020, primarily competing in EA Sports FC (unrelated to the Saudi Arabian team of the same name).



WHO AM I?

I'm a Mumbai-born gamer who started my professional journey in 2016. I got a nickname based on my gaming handle "SwiftBlade." I made history by being part of the first Indian team to reach the finals of The International Open Qualifiers for DOTA 2. Who am I? The answer will be revealed in the next issue.

Answer to previous issue's quiz:
Abhirup "Lightningfast" Choudhury



BUSINESS OF ESPORTS

Esports giant Konami extended its partnership with FIFA to promote football esports through FIFAe competitions until 2026.



EASTER EGG 'GANK'

Gank refers to multiple team members virtually converging to ambush and eliminate an opponent. It is usually a strategy used in Multiplayer Online Battle Arenas (MOBAs).

Rankings and quiz powered by NODWIN Gaming